

IDENTITY, NATION, NATIONALISM

MUSLIM NATIONALISM STAGES IN IMPERIAL
INDIA

IDENTITY/SURVIVAL

- The characteristics or qualities of any person or group that make them different from others (unique).
- Identity can manifest itself by various perspectives like:
 - gender, race, clan, family, (on a lesser level)
 - social, political, economic, intellectual, psychological, religious, historical, traditional, state, national, academic, technological, moral, cultural, territorial, linguistic, ethnic, (on a advanced level)

NATION

- Comes from root word **natio, nasci (Latin)**, to be born of common blood ties
- Came to popular use in English language in 13th century referred to inhabitants of same country
- Later on related to national identity and self determination
a group of people who have common ties based on any characteristics of identity (language, religion, culture, history, economy, politics etc.)
- For example Christianity unified large area under common faith, Islam unified warring Arab tribes

- Nation may have the following aspects

- Sense of belonging
- Love and unity among people
- Common hostilities
- Common territory
- Common sovereign government
- Common moral, social, economic ideas
- Common culture

➤ Political independence

➤ Common historical origin

➤ Common religion

➤ Common national character (symbolism related to historical, cultural, geographical, religious features)

➤ Devotion (territorial expansion, military power, scientific advancement or academic glory)

NATIONALISM

- It is a sentiment, a consciousness, a sympathy, which binds a group of people together. It is the desire of a group of individuals, who are already united by certain ties, to live together and, if necessary, to die together. It is the wish of a people, who feel that they are one, to go on living as one.
- Nationalism aims to build and maintain a single **national identity** based on shared social characteristics like culture, language, religion, politics or common history for promotion of national unity or solidarity.
- National symbols like national flags, national anthems, national languages may become important national symbols and crucial for national identity.

- There may be positive or negative outcomes of extreme forms of nationalism.
- For example important in independence movements like Pakistan movement where common religion became dynamic factor for partition of subcontinent, or Zionist movement that created modern Israel- an independent state for Jews also religion as a common factor for creation of state.
- Conversely extreme feeling of superiority and belief in one's nation leads to racial hatred. For example Holocaust conducted by Nazi German.

MUSLIM NATIONALISM IN IMPERIAL INDIA

EVOLUTION OF GROUP IN A NATION

- It is first stage and is based on historic and political dimensions
- Historical development of a group of people into nation by commonality of any aspect of **IDENTITY**
- It occurs on a longer time span may take centuries where common factors of identity creates concept of oneness
- For example introduction of Islamic principles in subcontinent and then the concept of nation took centuries to materialize

CONSCIOUSNESS OF SEPARATE EXISTENCE

- This second stage creates sense of separate existence in that group (nation) and it is based on justification of separate existence (sui generis).
- The foundations of this level is philosophical explanation of separate existence where they ponder over the reality of their existence.
- Other foundations may be religious or cultural
- The basic principles and ideals of separate identity are enunciated like the philosophical, intellectual, religious and cultural progress of Muslims in subcontinent under different dynasties like Delhi Sultanate or Mughal Empire.

SYMBOLISM OF REPRESENTATION

- This level creates sense of belonging and extreme ownership between the nation and their distinct separate identity.
- Different symbols are made that generates the feeling of relationship like flags, songs, anthems, slogans , literature or educational aims and institutions, political parties.
- It unites the people, psychologically motivates them and binds them together into one fabric of common identity with common aims and objectives to be achieved by them unitedly under consciousness of oneness
(NATIONALISM)

CULMINATION OF STRUGGLE

- This whole struggle culminates in last stage that is the achievement of a separate territory for themselves.
- The end of this struggle is the political independence where they can live according to their own system that have different, unique and distinct social, cultural, religious, political, economic and communal beliefs and ideals.
- In Imperial India, the struggle of Muslims materialized in independence of Pakistan based on their different identical foundations (**TWO NATION CONCEPT**).

STATE

A state has following components

- a territory
- with well defined borders
- certain population
- defensive capability
- strong and independent state institutions
- internal and external sovereignty